

PupSense™ Dog Food Scoring Guide

Clear, honest nutrition insights — without marketing noise.

What This Score Means

PupSense scores dog food from **0 to 100** based on ingredient quality, transparency, and nutritional value. Higher scores mean better-quality food with fewer compromises. This scale is intentionally strict: not every food above 50 deserves a recommendation.

Score Range	PupSense Rating	PlainEnglish Meaning
90–100	Elite	Outstanding ingredients with almost no red flags. Excellent daily choice.
80–89	Excellent	Highquality proteins and fats. Minor compromises only.
70–79	Good	Solid nutrition, but not perfect. Acceptable for most dogs.
60–69	Fair	Noticeable fillers or vague ingredients. There are better options.
50–59	Borderline	Too many tradeoffs to confidently recommend.
0–49	Poor	Lowquality ingredients or major red flags. Best avoided.

PupSense Tip: Aim for foods scoring **70+**. Lower scores don't always mean danger — but they do mean your dog deserves better nutrition if possible.

How to Read a Dog Food Ingredient List

Ingredient lists can be confusing on purpose. Here's how to quickly understand what really matters.

1. Look at the first 5 ingredients

About 80% of the food comes from the first five ingredients. If these are high-quality and clearly named, the food is usually better overall.

2. Named proteins beat vague ones

Good examples: Chicken, Beef, Salmon, Turkey meal.

Red flags: Meat by-products, animal fat, poultry digest.

3. Watch the carbs

Better carbs include sweet potatoes, oats, and brown rice. Too many peas, lentils, or corn often signal cost-cutting.

4. Fats should have a source

Chicken fat or salmon oil are good. Generic terms like "animal fat" lower food quality.

5. Fewer chemicals, more clarity

Natural preservatives (like vitamin E) are preferable. Artificial colors, flavors, or chemical preservatives are unnecessary.

Bottom line: Simple, recognizable ingredients usually mean better food. If you can't easily explain what's in the bag, your dog probably shouldn't eat it.